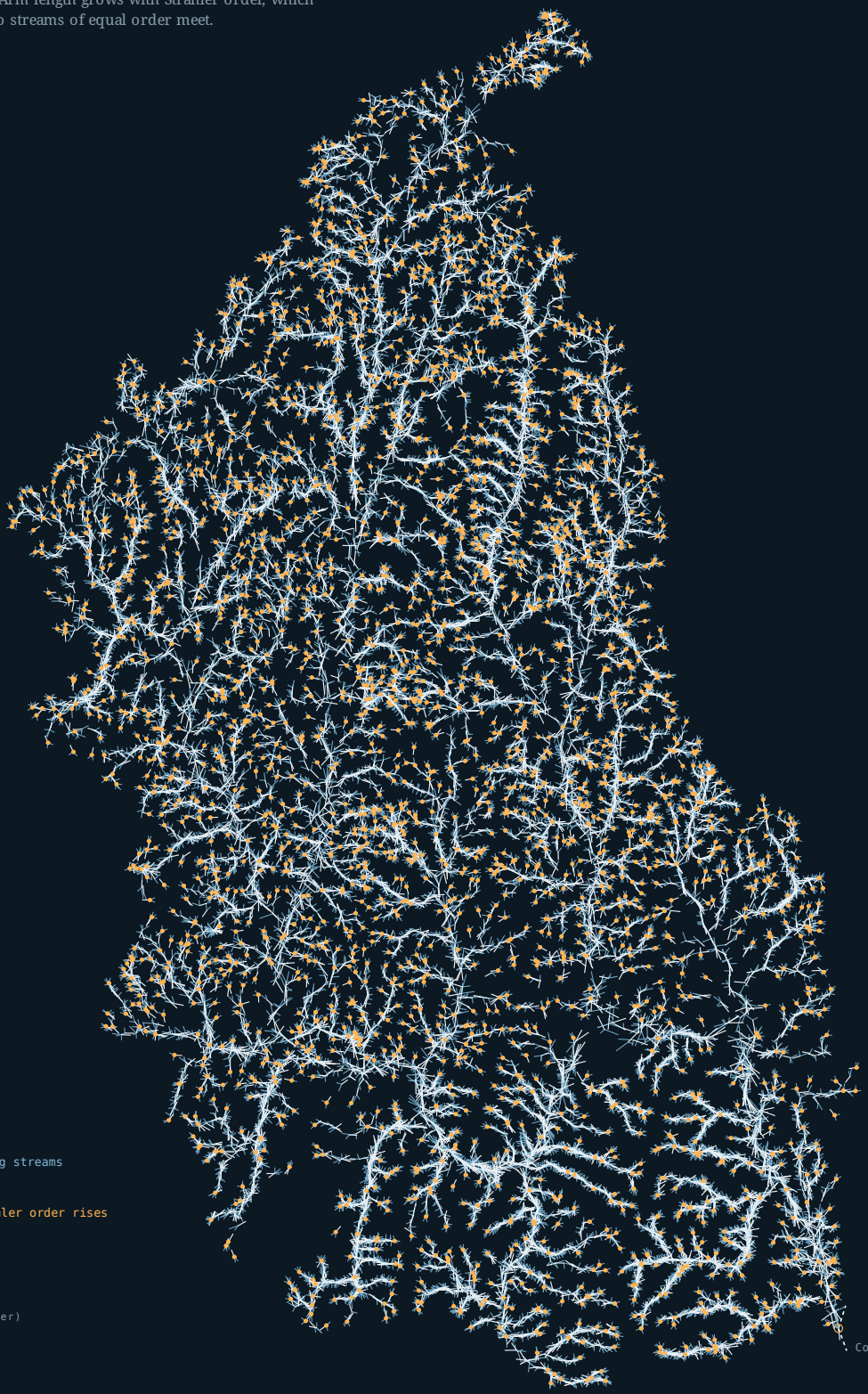
Every junction on the Kettle River

DAY 1 · POINTS · #30DAYMAPCHALLENGE

Each point is a stream junction, from the headwaters in British Columbia to the Columbia River in Washington. An arm runs up each joining stream and one down the outflow. Arm length grows with Strahler order, which rises by one only where two streams of equal order meet.



ARM LENGTH, ACTUAL SIZE (mm)

(example above drawn 4x larger)

- order 1: 0.8
- order 2: 1.1
- order 4: 1.6
- order 8: 2.2

Data: BC Freshwater Atlas, Province of British Columbia (contains information licensed under the Open Government Licence - British Columbia); USGS 3D Hydrography Program.
US channels under 1.5 km² of upstream area omitted. Map: Graham Watt, CC BY 4.0. Built in R and GRASS GIS with Claude Code (Anthropic). github.com/cordilleran/MapChallenge2026